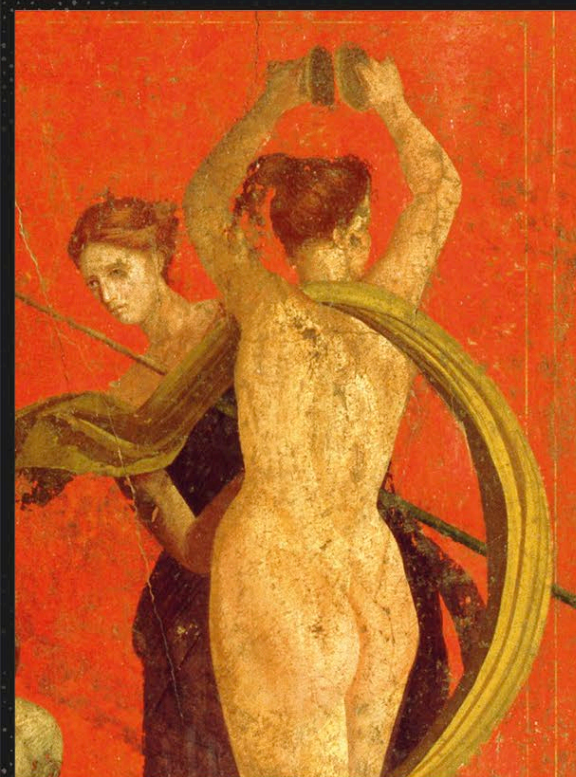


being magically treated (so, a yellow potion might cure jaundice)—was known to ancient Egyptians. The Greeks developed the concept of binding, that a magician could take physical or spiritual control of another person or object, even of a body as massive as the moon, through the proper rituals. As literary sources become more plentiful, there are even names for individual sorcerers, such as Circe, who in Homer's *Odyssey* enchanted Odysseus's companions and turned them into pigs, or Erichtho, the witch whom Roman poet Lucan recounts raised a corpse from the dead by pouring the spittle of a rabid dog upon it.

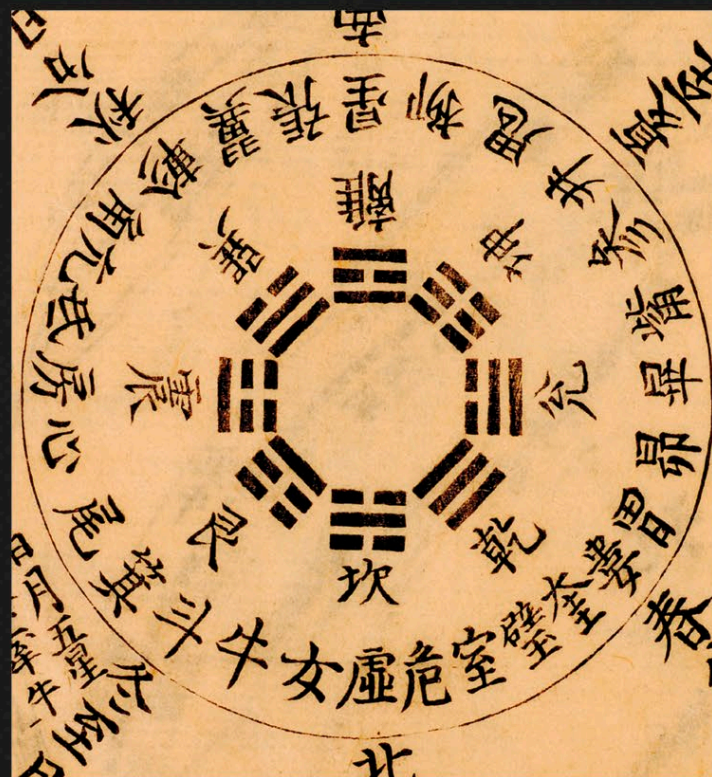
While many cultures produced specific, ordered rules for magic—few quite as many as Japan, which even had a ministry of magic—others retained a looser sense of the infinity of spiritual power. For the Maya, the observation of the cosmos and an awareness of vast cycles of time, the inhalation of psychotropic smoke to enter the spirit world, and the belief in spirit animals that accompanied powerful magicians echoed the earliest Neolithic magical beliefs. In the ancient world, chaos and death were never very far away and the desire to stave these off, if only for a short period, meant that magic was ever-present.

“Magic, by holding people's emotions in a triple bond ... holds sway over a great part of humanity.”

PLINY, *NATURALIS HISTORIA*, ON BELIEF IN MAGIC'S MEDICAL, RELIGIOUS, AND ASTROLOGICAL POWER, 1ST CENTURY CE



Pompeii fresco see p.45



Ancient Chinese energy map see p.53



Mayan codex see p.59